HOORVIA - WATERCOLOR WASHES: PRINTABLE TECHNIQUE GUIDE

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · US Letter Printable

Crafting & DIY · Sheet #1

Wash	What It Is	How	Best For
Flat wash	Even color across an area	Tilt the board, paint top to bottom	Skies, backgrounds
Graded wash	Color fades from dark to light	Add water as you go down	Skies, sunsets
Variegated wash	Two colors blend wet-in-wet	Drop colors into wet paint	Sunsets, water
Wet-in-wet	Paint into wet paper	Wet the paper first	Soft clouds, fog
Wet-on-dry	Paint on dry paper	Crisp edges	Details, sharp shapes
Glazing	Transparent layers	Let each layer dry	Depth, luminosity
Dry brush	Broken, textured strokes	Little water, dry brush	Grass, wood, fur
Lifting	Removing paint	Damp brush or sponge	Highlights, clouds
Splattering	Flicked paint drops	Flick a loaded brush	Stars, texture
Salt texture	Salt absorbs pigment	Sprinkle salt on wet paint	Snow, stars, texture
Charging	Dropping color into a wet wash	Drop paint into a wet area	Blooms, depth
Backruns	Water blooms in drying paint	More water in a damp wash	Texture (or a mistake)

PRO TIP: Mix more paint than you need: Running out mid-wash leaves a hard edge you cannot fix. Mix twice what you think you need - watercolor is cheap, a ruined wash is not.